

Sermon Outline

June 1, 2025

Joel 2:18-27 "God's Pity, Our Restoration"

Main Point: The LORD chose His people to reflect His image (character and nature), but when they turned from Him, He caused ruin to them as a nation in order to get their attention and in effect, return their affections back toward Himself, restoring all that was lost.

Point 1: Joel's Call To Return to the LORD (2:12-14)

- A. Return to Me with ALL your heart (2:12)
- B. Return to the LORD your God (2:13)
- C. If we return to Him, who knows whether He will relent (2:14)
 - a. Relent = Sorrow, regret, moved to pity, have compassion, suffer grief, to ease

Point 2: God's Jealousy, Pity & Compassion (2:18)

- A. God's jealousy = Deep devotion that leads to intervention and salvation (2:18)
- B. God's pity = To spare, have compassion on (2:18, Matt 14:10-14)
- C. God's compassion = His kindness is meant to bring about repentance (2:18, Rom 2:4)

Point 3: God's Answer to His People (2:18-27)

- A. Joel called for all to assemble to fast and pray for God to relent (2:15-17)
- B. The LORD answered by restoring all He took away (2:19-26)
- C. CHART: Ruin/Restoration (Joel 1-2)

Point 4: God's Kindness to His People is Only For His Glory (2:26-27)

- A. God's people will praise His name (2:26)
- B. God's people will no longer be a reproach - they will reflect Him (2:26)
- C. God's presence will be known and experienced (2:27)
- D. God people will remember that their God is God alone (2:27)
- E. God's mercy and grace is all about His glory, not ours (Deut 6:7-9)

Point 5: God Sent Jesus To Restore All Things

- A. Jesus came to free us (Luke 4:18)
- B. Jesus came to make all things new (2 Corinthians 5:17)
- C. Jesus came to reconcile us to God (Colossians 1:18-22)

Application Questions:

- A. Mediocre Christianity - are you playing games, or following with all your being?
- B. Life's Challenges - are these God's seeking to grab your affections again?
- C. True Repentance - what does humility and brokenness look like for you?
- D. Unending Joy - do you anticipate future restoration with joy and hopefulness?